FREE CHECKLIST

CAR Readiness Checklist

39 checks across the 5 GAID Schedule 2 areas, plus scoping and sign-off. Built for Nigerian DPCOs.

Client _____ CAR year _____

DPCO / lead consultant _____ Target filing date _____

How to use it

- **Run one copy per client.**
- **Tick only what has evidence.** A policy document without proof it is followed stays unticked.
- **Mark each item Ready, Partial or Gap**, and give every Partial or Gap an owner and a due date.
- **Start in Q4.** Evidence collection takes weeks per client.

○ Ready ○ Partial ○ Gap. Fill in the circle that applies.

Before you start: category and scope

	Check	Ready · Partial · Gap	Owner	Due
☐	Client's category confirmed as UHL or EHL, based on sector and data subjects processed in six months	○ ○ ○		
☐	Fee tier agreed with the client in writing	○ ○ ○		
☐	Client's NDPC registration is current	○ ○ ○		
☐	Client contacts, evidence deadlines and sign-off authority agreed	○ ○ ○		
☐	Last year's CAR and open remediation items collected	○ ○ ○		

Area 1: Governance

	Check	Ready · Partial · Gap	Owner	Due
☐	Data Protection Officer appointed, with name, contact and reporting line documented	○ ○ ○		
☐	DPO training or qualification records on file	○ ○ ○		
☐	Data protection policy approved by management or the board	○ ○ ○		
☐	Privacy notice published wherever data is collected (website, apps, forms)	○ ○ ○		
☐	Staff data protection training delivered this year, with attendance records	○ ○ ○		
☐	Data protection roles and responsibilities documented	○ ○ ○		

Area 2: Data security controls

	Check	Ready · Partial · Gap	Owner	Due
☐	Access control policy, with evidence of role-based access	○ ○ ○		
☐	Encryption of personal data at rest and in transit	○ ○ ○		
☐	Breach response plan, tested at least once this year	○ ○ ○		
☐	Breach register, including any NDPC notifications made	○ ○ ○		
☐	Vulnerability assessment or penetration test report from this year	○ ○ ○		
☐	Backups tested for recovery	○ ○ ○		
☐	Physical security for paper records	○ ○ ○		

Area 3: Accountability and risk

The area where most CARs stall. Ask for records, not policies.

	Check	Ready · Partial · Gap	Owner	Due
☐	Record of processing activities (ROPA), complete and current	○ ○ ○		
☐	Lawful basis documented for each processing activity	○ ○ ○		
☐	Consent records, where consent is the lawful basis	○ ○ ○		
☐	DPIAs for high-risk processing, using the GAID Schedule 4 template	○ ○ ○		
☐	DSAR log with request dates, response dates and outcomes	○ ○ ○		
☐	Retention schedule, with evidence of disposal	○ ○ ○		
☐	Data protection risk register	○ ○ ○		

Area 4: Cross-border transfer

	Check	Ready · Partial · Gap	Owner	Due
☐	Inventory of personal data leaving Nigeria: destination, data type, recipient	○ ○ ○		
☐	Documented legal basis or safeguard for each transfer	○ ○ ○		
☐	Cloud and hosting locations confirmed for every system holding personal data	○ ○ ○		

Area 5: Third-party data processors

The other common gap. Vendors are often missing from the evidence pack entirely.

	Check	Ready · Partial · Gap	Owner	Due
☐	Processor and vendor list, with the personal data each one handles	○ ○ ○		
☐	Signed data processing agreement for every processor	○ ○ ○		
☐	Due-diligence records from before each processor was onboarded	○ ○ ○		
☐	Sub-processors identified for key vendors	○ ○ ○		

	Check	Ready · Partial · Gap	Owner	Due
☐	Evidence of a periodic processor review this year	○ ○ ○		

Filing and sign-off

	Check	Ready · Partial · Gap	Owner	Due
☐	Gap analysis complete, with a Ready / Partial / Gap score for each area	○ ○ ○		
☐	Remediation agreed for every gap the client can close before filing	○ ○ ○		
☐	CAR drafted on the GAID Schedule 2 template, each finding traced to its evidence	○ ○ ○		
☐	Written approval from the client's authorised signatory	○ ○ ○		
☐	Filed on the NDPC portal, fee paid, confirmation and receipt saved	○ ○ ○		
☐	Remediation plan for open items handed to the client	○ ○ ○		

This checklist is practical guidance, not legal advice. Confirm current requirements with the GAID and the NDPC before filing.

Run this checklist inside DPO Copilot: evidence uploads, readiness scores and sign-off in one workspace.